

Chekai (Jacie) Lin

CINEMATOGRAPHER · CAMERA OPERATOR · DIRECTOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cinematographer with 10+ years capturing customer stories, product and brand films, technical explainers, executive interviews, and live events, most of it as a self-sufficient one-person field unit working documentary-style in changing conditions. M.F.A. in Motion Picture and Television. Hands-on with cinema cameras (Sony, ARRI, RED, Blackmagic), lighting and grip, location audio, still photography, and drone aerials, with DaVinci Resolve and Adobe post skills and disciplined DIT and metadata practices for clean handoffs to editors. Comfortable making creative decisions on location, directing non-actor talent, and coordinating crews and vendors. Based in the Bay Area; available for 30%+ domestic and international travel and flexible hours.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Creative Director & Cinematographer NexGenT · Remote / Bay Area Jul 2020 – Present

- Primary cinematographer and camera operator for a national brand: customer case studies and testimonials shot on location, product launches and explainer videos, YouTube long-form, ads, and live events, delivering footage for social, brand, and internal communications.
- Plan and execute shoots end to end with producers and stakeholders: shot lists, location scouting, camera and lens selection, lighting and grip design, location audio, on-set stills, and media management / DIT with consistent metadata for a fast, organized handoff to editors.
- Write interview questions and direct customers, students, and executives on camera, anticipating unscripted moments and capturing dialogue and B-roll that turn technical subject matter into clear, emotionally engaging stories.
- Built and maintain a consistent brand look across recurring formats; helped grow the YouTube channel past 100K subscribers and supplied footage for a series that reached 13M+ views.
- Manage two or more concurrent productions; designed and delivered two in-house studios in one month at 60% under budget, owning camera, lighting, audio, and production-readiness decisions.

Cinematographer & Editor Lead NexGenT · San Jose, CA Oct 2017 – Jun 2020

- Joined as employee #10 with no video team, studio, or camera; built the video function from zero and produced work that reached 4.1M views and increased brand exposure by 55%.
- Directed run-and-gun field production at Cisco Live 2019 and authored video standards adopted across the instructor team, setting the technical and creative bar for internal and external contributors.

Cinematographer General Motors · Detroit, MI & Phoenix, AZ Mar – Apr 2017

- Directed and filmed General Motors' 20th-anniversary documentary, interviewing senior leaders; storyboards and pre-lit setups reduced shooting time by 20%.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.F.A., Motion Picture and Television Academy of Art University 2014 – 2017

B.S., Information Communication Yuan Ze University 2009 – 2013

FAA Part 107 Remote Pilot Certificate In progress Exam scheduled 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cinematography & Camera Operation Composition, framing, camera movement, lens selection, and exposure; visual continuity; controlled studio and field production; documentary, product demo, launch, and branded content

Lighting, Grip, Audio & On-Set Production Lighting and grip design in studio and on location; location sound and interview audio; on-camera direction; run-and-gun production; live-event coverage

Aerial & Still Photography DJI Inspire 2 aerial videography and photography (FAA Part 107 exam scheduled 2026); on-set stills with Nikon Z9; product and site photography

Post-Production & Media Management DaVinci Resolve color grading with Dehancer; Adobe Premiere Pro, Lightroom, Photoshop; Final Cut Pro; iZotope RX; DIT with verified offloads, consistent naming and metadata, and organized handoff to editors; codecs and delivery for broadcast and social

Pre-Production & Coordination Shot lists; storyboards; location scouting; interview development; crew, talent, gear, and location logistics; vendor coordination; studio builds; brand and visual standards

AI-Assisted Previsualization Seedance; Claude; Higgsfield; advanced prompt design; cinematic concept and visual development

Camera Systems & Equipment Sony FX3, FX6, FX30, F55; Nikon Z9; Blackmagic URSA Mini; ARRI Alexa; RED Weapon; DJI Inspire 2; owned camera bodies, lenses, lighting, and audio equipment